

# ABHINAV KAUSHIK

**Staff / Principal Applied AI Researcher (Agentic Search)**

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Hiring Team

Nebius

**Re: Staff / Principal Applied AI Researcher (Agentic Search)**

Dear Hiring Team,

I'm applying for the Staff / Principal Applied AI Researcher (Agentic Search) role because the work sits close to a part of my background I have built in production: retrieval, ranking and recommendation systems. I'm a Senior AI Engineer with 8+ years of experience across healthcare, telecom and AIOps, and my recent work has increasingly focused on making model outputs useful inside real applications.

What interests me about Nebius is the search and ranking problem behind this role, where the quality of retrieval and ordering has a direct effect on the user experience. My fiancée lives in Berlin, and we plan to move to Switzerland together and settle there long term.

At UnitedHealth Group, I fine-tuned a cross-encoder on positive and negative pairs for dense retrieval over AARP survey data. Earlier at Optum, I built a reranker for individual and child plan recommendations that increased conversion by 2%. That work gives me direct experience with retrieval quality, ranking and model evaluation, alongside Python, SQL and PySpark.

Alongside my professional work, I am building ThinkTree.AI, a non-profit AI learning platform used by NGO teachers to support students with ADHD. Building it for real users keeps me focused on clarity, reliability and the experience around the technology, not just the model. I would welcome the opportunity to discuss how my background could contribute to the team.

Thank you,

Abhinav Kaushik